

WHICH DTH TV FOR YOU?

Are you sick of your cable TV operator and considering getting a DTH connection? Here are some things to know before you get one!

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Not long before Tata Sky and Dish TV vied for the satellite TV space in India. The war has just hot up with the entries of Sun Direct, Reliance Big TV and Airtel Digital TV in this space. And now consumer durables maker Videocon too is planning DTH foray.

Not surprisingly, the increasing number of players has driven down the price of the set-top boxes, adversely impacting the profitability of the ventures. The beneficiary of this price war is obviously the consumer. But, given the too many options, you are likely to get confused as to which is better for you. Here is the way to go.

What is DTH TV?

Before going any further, let me explain the basics of satellite TV. Satellite TV, or direct-to-home (DTH) TV, lets you receive TV signals directly from the satellite through a set-top box. That means there is no middleman (cable operator). So DTH puts an end to all the problems like unreasonable charges, cable operators' strike, power outages, not getting your favourite channels and channels shifting their channel number positions.

In satellite TV, you receive the signal from a satellite (which the broadcaster has hired) to a small dish antenna installed at the rooftop of your house, or an outer wall of your flat. This signal is decoded by a set-top box, which is provided by the broadcaster and connects to the dish antenna directly with a cable. The set-top box, in

turn, connects to your TV.

So you become the master of your entertainment. Watch the channels you wish. And pay for only those channels which you wish to watch; you need not pay for Sports channels if you don't like sports.

Advantages of DTH TV

Digital picture. The picture quality in DTH TV is much better. The quality of picture is uniform across all channels, whereas in cable the quality of picture is inconsistent—some channels are clear but the balance are fuzzy and snowy.

Digital audio. You get the stereophonic sound. So if you've got a home

theatre, connect it to your set-top box. You'll get better sound effects.

Electronic programme guide (EPG). It's an on-screen guide that shows the programme schedule or listing of all the channels. So you can find out what's playing on any channel. You can also set reminders for programmes you wish to watch and get synopses of the programmes. Set up your favourite channel list. The list of EPG features varies from broadcaster to broadcaster.

Payment modes. You pay only for what you watch. Payment is in advance. Recharge is easy with various sources like the Internet, mobile phones, vouchers from vendors, etc.

